

Before You Reopen the Decision

Use this before you re-run the comparison. Ten to twenty minutes. If you finish it and the decision needs to change, change it. If you finish it and nothing has actually changed, you have your answer without spending a day on it. Keep completed sheets; they are the record you check the next one against.

1. The decision as it was made

What I decided (one sentence; the thing, not the reasons)

When, and what has already been done because of it (actions taken, people told, money spent, things posted or signed)

What I rejected, and why (one line each)

The reasons and assumptions it rested on (up to three; if you cannot recall them, write your best reconstruction and mark it "reconstructed")

1.

2.

3.

What the original comparison did not consider, if anything comes to mind now

2. What is prompting this reopen

What happened (the event, comment, article, feeling, or nothing; be exact)

What kind of thing it is (tick one)

- ☐ A fact I did not have
- ☐ Someone's opinion or reaction
- ☐ A feeling, with no external content
- ☐ A new option that did not exist before
- ☐ I think the original reasoning had a mistake in it

An opinion or a feeling can point at something worth checking. It does not by itself justify reversal. If you ticked either, write the specific question it raises, then answer Section 3 for that question:

3. Does it change anything?

What it touches (tick all that apply)

- ☐ A reason or assumption in Section 1 (which: ____)
- ☐ A factor the original comparison left out
- ☐ A priority of mine that has changed since
- ☐ An option that was not available then
- ☐ An error in the original reasoning
- ☐ Nothing in the decision → go to Section 5

What I believed then, and what I believe now

With that one change, and everything else as it was, does the original decision still come out ahead?

☐ Yes, clearly ☐ Yes, by less ☐ No longer clear ☐ No

4. What would justify reassessing

Conditions under which this decision should be deliberately re-evaluated (numbers and dates where possible; if these were written when you decided, copy them; if not, write them now and treat them as provisional. Meeting one means a re-evaluation, not an automatic reversal.)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Is any of them met right now? ☐ Yes: condition ____ ☐ No ☐ Cannot tell without: _____ by _____

5. The cost of keeping this open

Time spent on this reopen so far: _____ **Actions waiting on it:** _____

What it costs other people (colleagues waiting, a partner tired of the topic, someone left hanging)

What it costs the next decision (slower to commit, less trust in the process, or nothing)

6. Verdict

☐ **Stands.** Nothing in the decision changed. Close it.

☐ **Stands, with a condition added.** One reason is softer than it was. Add a condition to Section 4 and close it.

☐ **Modify.** The decision holds in outline; one element changes: _____

☐ **Reverse.** On re-evaluation, the decision no longer comes out ahead in Section 3, whether or not a Section 4 condition prompted it.

☐ **Investigate one specific question, then close.** The question: _____ By: _____

7. Next action and review point

The next concrete action, and when

The review point (a date or an event; until then the decision is closed, and any urge to reopen comes back to this sheet, not to the spreadsheet)

If the urge returns before the review point, I will: write down what prompted it and run it through Section 3: does it touch a reason in Section 1, a factor the comparison left out, a changed priority, a new option, or an error in the original reasoning? If it touches none of these and no Section 4 condition is met, close it. If it touches one, reopen that point on purpose.

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